

Calming Breath

Orientation springs from a state of peace. In this meditation you will say the word “calm” to yourself. Calm is another outcome of peace, because true peace is the absence of conflict among the internal factors in our lives. In the absence of conflict we experience calm, and in the calm we can be oriented.

1. Take the meditation posture. Breathe. Settle in to this experience or experiment. You might begin with a silent prayer for help in learning peace within yourself and in your life.
2. As you inhale, try to feel for any tension in your body. As you exhale, try to release the tension. Let your muscles drop or relax. If you cannot relax a particular muscle, make a note of it in your mind. This may be an area that needs more attention. Just notice the tension for now, and then continue to scan other areas of your body. Relax and breathe.
3. When you feel ready, use the word “calm” as a centering word. Say “calm” to yourself as you exhale and release tension. Practice this for 3 minutes.

During this time, you might want to touch the finger tips of your two hands together. This can naturally calm the nervous system and train the body to calm itself in response to a physical signal. If it is more comfortable, connect your thumb with one of your fingers on the same hand. Explore which finger and thumb combination feels the most calming for you.

4. Now, let go of the word “calm” and the physical signal, and rest in the stillness for one minute.
5. Gently stretch, open your eyes, and re-engage with the world around you.

James writes, “For the fruit of orientation is planted in peace by those who make peace.” Take time throughout the day to calm yourself and give God a chance to guide your True Self.